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ECZ bars Binwell

...as the Commission revokes his accreditation to access the National Results Centre

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Dozens feared dead on Lake Kariba

By Ruth Kambita

Dozens of people are feared dead after a passenger ferry capsized on Lake Kariba in Zimbabwe this afternoon.

However, at least 53 people have so far been rescued after rescue operations involving even helicopters.

It has not yet been established if any of the victims are Zambians as rescue operations are still on.

According to ZBC, the Rural Infrastructure Development Agency (RIDA) vessel, carrying 90 passengers and five crew members, overturned near Long Island while travelling from Kariba Urban to Chalala Fishing Camp.

The Zimbabwe Republic Police confirmed the incident and said a search-and-rescue operation was under way for those still unaccounted for.

Authorities have not yet confirmed whether there were any fatalities or released an official death toll.

The circumstances surrounding the accident remain unclear. Rescue teams continue to scour the area as efforts to locate missing passengers and crew members continue.



Binwell Mpundu

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Real News in Real Time

ECZ bars Binwell

By Ruth Kambita

The Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) has with immediate effect revoked the accreditation of the Former Member of Parliament for Nkana Constituency Binwell Mpundu to access the National Results Centre.

Mr Mpundu had been

accredited following his nomination by the National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP) in a letter dated 30 July 2026.

The revocation follows a video attributed to Mr Mpundu that circulated on social media in which he is alleged to have made threats and indicated readiness to use violence dur-

ing the electoral process.

In a statement issued this evening, ECZ Chief Electoral Officer Brown Kasaro said the conduct was of "serious concern" and had the potential to incite violence, create public unrest and undermine the peaceful conduct of the election.

"The commission consid-

ers statements of this nature a direct threat to the integrity, security and peaceful conduct of the electoral process," Mr Kasaro said.

He cited Section 77(6) of the Electoral Process Act and Paragraph 11(1)(c) of the Electoral Code as the legal basis for the revocation and for any further action the commission may take.

Mr Kasaro warned stakeholders to remain peaceful and cautioned against making statements or taking actions that could compromise public safety and security.

He said the Commission will not hesitate to take appropriate action within the law against any accredited person whose conduct threatens the election.

Mr Kasaro has urged political parties and candidates to publicly condemn violence and to cooperate with authorities to ensure a peaceful electoral process.

Monze man defiles girl 13 flees

By Ruth Kambita

A 25-year-old man of Monze District is on the run after allegedly defiling a 13-year-old girl during a wedding event.

The incident is alleged to have occurred on August 8, 2026, around 23:00 hours, when the victim went to a toilet near her home with a friend. The friend later returned alone, assuming that the victim had already gone back.

Southern Province Police Commanding Officer Moono Namalongo said the victim's mother returned home around midnight and found her asleep.

Mr Namalongo said the juvenile later disclosed that she had been sexually assaulted near the pit latrine.

He said the suspect allegedly restrained the victim by covering her mouth before sexually assaulting her.

Mr Namalongo said police

had issued a medical report form to the victim and opened a docket, while investigations were underway to apprehend the suspect.

"The Zambia Police Service wishes to remind the public that defilement is a serious criminal offence. Any sexual activity with a child constitutes defilement, regardless of alleged consent, and offenders will face the full force of the law," he said.

Pule calls for peace

By Linda Nyondo

The Christian Democratic Party has called on all aspiring Presidential candidates to urge their supporters and sympathizers to stop perpetrating violence.

The party believes that aspiring Presidential candidates have authority to decree something and their members will do as told.

Party President, Danny Pule says there is no need to perpetrate violence. Instead, he called for peace.

"It is important to have regard for fellow human beings. I am appealing to my fellow Presidential aspirants to take the lead and caution our supporters to refrain from perpetrating violence," he says.

Meanwhile, Apostle Pule says he will work towards reducing poverty levels by implementing various programmes.

He says the cost of living was too high hence the need to ensure that programmes aimed at improving the welfare of people and eradicating poverty are implemented.

The party has also promised to reduce the cost of meals from the current K200 per 25kilograms of mealie meal to K150.

They have further pledged to triple the production of essential commodities.

Apostle Pule has further

promised to distribute 10 bags of fertilizer per beneficiary under the Farmer Input Support Programme (FISP).

He has further promised to prioritise Zambians when it comes to allocation of land.

"It is totally unacceptable to relocate people from their traditional land and offer it to foreigners," Apostle Pule says.

He was however quick to point out that they appreciate what foreign investors do.

However, his emphasis is on prioritising Zambians.

He also said that should the party consider allocating land to foreigners, priority will be given to Zambians.

Apostle Pule has also promised to implement free education from early childhood learning up until Tertiary level.

He says education is the only way to reduce and subsequently eradicate poverty.

Apostle Pule has also promised to improve infrastructure and the road network system.

He has further declared his readiness to take up the leadership of becoming the President of Zambia.

"I am confident that I and all the aspiring candidates in our party will win elections," he says.

Apostle Pule says he and his entire leadership are ready to provide leadership which is inspired by God.

ECZ backed on ballot marking law

By Alex Maboshe

The Southern African Centre for the Constructive Resolution of Disputes (SACCORD) says the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) is acting within the law regarding how voters mark ballot papers.

This follows claims that the ECZ has altered the rules on ballot markings ahead of the 13 August general election.

SACCORD Executive Director Arthur Muyunda noted that no one has instructed the ECZ to change the law.

He said the provision on ballot

markings has always existed in the legislation.

Mr Muyunda explained that Section 60 of the amended Electoral Process Act of 2026 allows voters to mark their ballot in any manner within the box corresponding to their preferred candidate, including with an X or a tick.

He urged political players and other stakeholders to familiarise themselves with the amended Act to avoid unnecessary misunderstandings as the country heads to the polls.

Broadcasters warned

By Alex Maboshe

The Independent Broadcasting Authority (IBA) has cautioned broadcasters against airing speculative, projected or unverified election results as Zambia heads to the polls on Thursday, August 13, 2026.

Speaking at a press briefing today in Lusaka, IBA Director-General Webster Malido urged media houses to strictly follow the 2026 Election Coverage Guidelines throughout the electoral period.

He stressed that all election-related content must be accurate, balanced, fair and thoroughly verified, especially during this sensitive stage of the process.

Broadcasters may report on the progress of voting, counting and tallying, Mr. Malido said, but they must not announce projected or speculative results before the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) makes an official declaration.

Results should only be broadcast once formally announced by the ECZ.

He further reminded stations that campaign interviews with political parties or candidates must not be aired on Election Day, and predictions about the election outcome are also prohibited.

The IBA advised media houses to handle information from social media, political actors, commentators and other unofficial sources with particular caution.

Relying on unverified material risks spreading misinformation and creating confusion among voters, Mr. Malido warned.

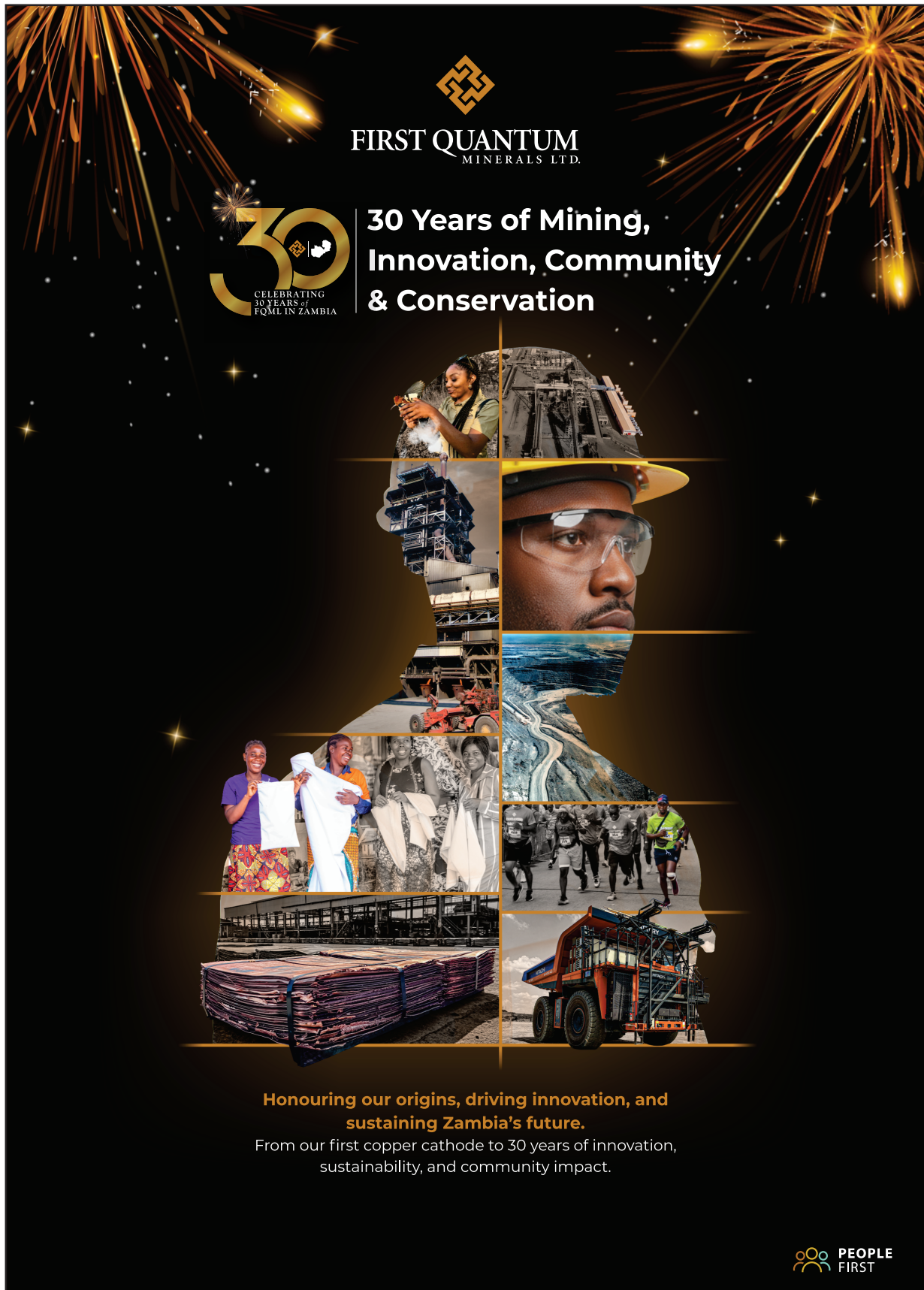
He also called for fair and equitable coverage of all political parties and candidates, and urged broadcasters to avoid content that promotes hate speech, tribalism or political violence.

Members of the public, political parties and candidates with complaints about election coverage should first approach the relevant broadcasting station, which is expected to respond within two days during the election period.

If the matter remains unresolved or the complainant is dissatisfied, it may then be escalated to the IBA for investigation and possible action.

Mr. Malido said the IBA will continue monitoring election-related broadcasts to ensure compliance with the law and the 2026 guidelines.

The regulator's warning showcases the importance of responsible broadcasting, rigorous verification and the media's role in safeguarding the integrity of the electoral process.



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NAPSA quick-pays K9m to 565 pensioners

By Ruth Kambita

The National Pension Scheme Authority (NAPSA) has paid K9,137,772.92 in interest-free advance pension payments to 565 pensioners,

providing immediate relief to retirees grappling with urgent bills and rising living costs. Launched on August 8 under the new NAPSA Act No. 72 of 2026, the advance

facility saw payments completed within three days, NAPSA said. The average advance was K16,178.37; the highest payment was K17,454.37 and the lowest K2,000.00.

“The strong uptake of this facility demonstrates the positive impact of the reforms on the lives of pensioners,” NAPSA Director-General Muyangwa Muyangwa said, noting the

advances helped beneficiaries avoid additional debt. NAPSA thanked President Hakainde Hichilema and the Board of Trustees for strategic oversight and support in implementing the reforms.

The authority said the advance is one of several measures introduced by the 2026 reforms, which also include enhanced minimum pensions, improved accrual and income-replacement rates, and new supplementary savings and pension products aimed at strengthening retirement security. The speedy roll-out marks a milestone in NAPSA's shift toward member-centred social security, turning legislative reform into immediate cash relief for a subset of retirees while signalling broader systemic changes for thousands more. Recipients reported using the money for medical bills, household needs and to settle debts, illustrating how the facility fills urgent gaps that monthly pensions cannot. NAPSA said it remains committed to implementing the full suite of reforms and new products to improve pensioners' welfare and dignity. This is contained in a statement issued by NAPSA Head of Corporate Affairs Cephas Sinyangwe.

We are ready - IG

By Ruth Kambita

Inspector General of Police Graphel Musamba says the Zambia Police Service is fully prepared to secure Thursday's general election, assuring citizens that officers will remain professional, impartial and committed to protecting peace and democratic rights. Mr Musamba said the campaign period had been largely peaceful, with only isolated incidents recorded. He said the police had finalised a nationwide deployment

plan, including the posting of additional officers at polling stations and tally centres to enhance visibility, improve response times and reassure communities. Similar measures have been reported as part of the police's wider election-security preparations. He said mobile patrols, crime-detection operations and rapid-response teams had also been strengthened in all provinces to ensure that eligible voters could cast their ballots freely and without intimidation.

The Inspector General of Police said the police would continue working with the Electoral Commission of Zambia, political parties, civil society organisations and local and international observer missions to protect election materials, polling stations and election officials. He warned that unlawful assemblies, road blockages, destruction of property, attacks and other conduct threatening public order would attract immediate police intervention and prosecution, regardless of political affiliation.

Mr Musamba reminded political parties that Article 60 of the Constitution prohibits the encouragement of violence and intimidation. He further urged voters to return home after casting their ballots and avoid loitering around polling stations unless they were accredited by the Electoral Commission of Zambia. The Inspector General of Police also warned citizens against spreading misinformation, hate speech, incitement and unverified election results on social media, saying those

who misuse digital platforms to undermine peace would be arrested. Police have separately advised the public to rely on official and authorised sources for election results. Mr Musamba directed police officers to discharge their duties with professionalism, integrity, neutrality and respect for human rights. He called on Zambians to reject violence and demonstrate the country's commitment to peaceful democracy.



Verification of ballot papers in Mongu today ahead of the 13 August 2026 General Elections. Pictures by Wasamunu Mubita ZANIS.



Vubwi man flees with 36 voters' cards

By Ruth Kambita

A man believed to be a member of the Tonse Alliance has been arrested and another is on the run after 36 voter registration cards were allegedly collected in exchange for United Party for National Development (UPND) regalia. The incident occurred on July 25, 2026, at about 15:00 hours in Zozwe Ward, Vubwi District. According to Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba, suspects Stanley Banda and Jacob Banda approached Bertha Phiri and Gladys Phiri and asked them to mobilise registered voters. The mobilised voters were then allegedly persuaded to surrender their voter cards in return for UPND party regalia and were told they would assist with campaign activities — a promise police say was false. “Thirty-six voters' cards were collected from people in the Vubwi area,” Mr Mweemba said. “After receiving the report, investigations were instituted and one suspect, Stanley Banda, was arrested and detained to assist with investigations. The other suspect, Jacob Mwanza, is currently at large and is believed to be in possession of the 36 voters' cards.” A docket has been opened and the arrested suspect is expected to appear in court soon, Mr Mweemba added.

‘No working, go and vote’

By Ruth Kambita

Government has declared Thursday, August 13, 2026, a public holiday to enable citizens to vote in the general election, with normal work

resuming on Friday, August 14. Secretary to the Cabinet Patrick Kangwa announced the declaration in Cabinet Office Circular No. 12 of 2026, citing Article 56(1) and (2) of the Constitution, as amended in 2016, which mandates that Election

Day be a public holiday. The 2026 general election, held every five years on the second Thursday of August, will see Zambians vote for President and Vice-President, Members of Parliament, Mayors, Council Chairpersons and

Councillors. Mr Kangwa said the holiday is intended to “accord all eligible voters an opportunity to participate in the elections.” He directed all heads of government institutions and statutory bodies to urgently

bring the circular to the attention of employees under their supervision. The Electoral Commission of Zambia has set polling hours from 06:00 to 18:00, with voters in queue by closing time allowed to cast their ballots.

Zambia enters Billie Jean King women’s tennis series in Abidjan



By Benedict Tembo

For the first time, Zambia will this year compete in the Billie Jean King Cup women’s tennis series by Gainbridge Africa Group IV Regional Event in Côte d’Ivoire. The tournament in Abidjan starts today and ends on Sunday. The four woman Zambian team will compete in Event ‘A’ alongside Congo, the DR Congo, Seychelles, Tanzania, Togo, and Uganda. The team, led by Emmanuel Chewes, comprises the Chisongo twins - Christabel and Isabel, Natasha Chewes and Soraya Mumena all from Green Buffaloes but carry the dreams of a nation with them. “This is more than a tournament. It’s the start of a new chapter for Zambian women’s tennis. These ladies will fly our flag, fight for every point, and show Africa what Zambian grit looks like. We are so proud of you. Go make history girls,” a Zambia Tennis Association statement announced yesterday. The four players have been active since Zambia hosted the ITF World Tennis Tour Juniors J30 Lusaka. The quartet played in the Zambia Closed Senior Tennis Championships in July in Ndola as well as the Davis Cup held in Congo Brazzaville from July 22 to 25.

Power back from SA training camp, ready to defend league title

By Benedict Tembo



Champion club Power Dynamos have returned home after a 12 day, six match training camp in South Africa with coach Oswald Mutapa saying his club was ready to successfully launch the CAF Champions League campaign as well as defend their league title. Power begin the TotalEnergies CAF Champions League campaign against Al Merrikh of Sudan next month with the first leg set for the Amahoro Stadium in Kigali. After the training camp in Pretoria, Mutapa was pleased with the work done during the 12-day, six match pre-season camp. He said he was happy the stint had achieved its intended objectives. The team played six matches in 12 days, giving the players the much-needed game mileage ahead of the Transitional season which kicks off on September 12. Power have been drawn in Stream A alongside MUZA, Kansanshi Dynamos, Konkola Blades, Makeni All Stars, Napsa

Stars, Nchanga Rangers, Nkana, Trident and Zanaco. “It has gone on well. We have had a good 12 days where we have played six games, and it’s important because we needed mileage in the legs of our players. I think six games in 12 days is enough to put mileage in their legs,” Mutapa said. The coach said the camp also provided an opportunity for the squad to build chemistry, particularly with the arrival of several new players. Among the new players Power have roped in include Wilson Chisala (central midfielder from Nkana), Hiver Amine (Chadian striker who had a stint with Zesco United), Mathews Chabala (defender from Zesco United), Nabwire Marvin (attacking midfielder from Police FC of Kenya) and Joshua ‘Buddo’ Mutale who was recently released by Tanzanian giants Simba. “The players have also been trying to bond with the new players that have come in as we pursue retaining the league and

prepare for CAF,” he said. Mutapa believes the team’s objectives in Pretoria had been met and is encouraged by the quality brought in by the new signings. “Our objectives have been met. What we wanted was to have mileage in the legs of our players. You could see that we have brought in quality from the new players,” the gaffer said. The team is expected to return home this morning as preparations continue for the new season, with the focus now shifting to defending the MTN Super League league title and preparing for TotalEnergies CAF Champions League. Mutapa wished the MTN Super League should have kicked off to help fine tune his team for the continental challenge. In the absence of the league, Power will participate in a four-team tournament as part of their preparations for the 2025-2026 CAF Champions League.

‘Journeyman’ Chipeco appointed Zesco Utd as top coach

By Benedict Tembo

Zesco United have appointed former Nkana trainer Mwenya Chipeco as the club’s new head coach. Chipeco will be supported by Tenant Chembo, who rejoins the Zesco technical bench as first assistant coach. Chipeco brings a wealth of experience and a proven winning record to the ZESCO United FC technical bench. A Confederation of African Football (CAF) A Licence holder, Chipeco has coached several top-flight Zambian football clubs, including Power Dynamos, Prison Leopards, Indeni, Forest Rangers and Nkana FC. His standout accomplishment is a super league champion’s title with Power Dynamos FC where he also gained continental experience in the CAF Champions League. Chipeco’s track record is complemented with a demonstrated ability to turn teams around for noticeable success. Chembo returns to ZESCO bringing extensive experience both as a player and coach. Chembo has built a distinguished coaching career with ZESCO, Mufulira Wanderers, Lumwana Radiants, Forest Rangers, Indeni and Ndola United.

His time at ZESCO United FC includes being part of the technical setup that won the 2016 Barclays Cup (now ABSA Cup) and the 2017 FAZ Super League title, while also gaining valuable CAF Champions League experience. “With his deep understanding of the club, Zambian football and years of experience on the technical bench, Chembo brings continuity, knowledge and leadership to the new ZESCO United FC setup,” Zesco said in a statement yesterday. The complete technical and support team includes Mwape Mwelwa as second assistant coach and Winston Kalengo who was care-taker coach towards the end of last season reverts to his previous role as physical trainer. Others are Kondwani Mtonga (physical trainer), Simon Silwimba (equipment manager) and Kabamba Kalande (team manager). The rest are Abidan Chansa (team doctor) and Stephen Mbewe (team clinician). “The appointments form part of the club’s preparations for success going forward, and its commitment to building a strong, professional and competitive technical structure capable of achieving the club’s objectives,” the statement said.

